

MS WORD ESSENTIALS · CHAPTER SERIES

MS Word Essentials

Chapter 1 · Getting Started with MS Word



Course Roadmap — 20 Chapters

MS Word Essentials · Guided practice every chapter, full assignment every 4

01	Getting Started with MS Word	11	Inserting Images & Shapes
02	Basic Text Entry & Editing	12	Styles & Themes
03	Character Formatting	13	Using Templates
04	Paragraph Formatting	14	Spelling, Grammar & Proofing
05	Practice Assignment 1	15	Practice Assignment 3
06	Working with Lists	16	Track Changes & Reviewing
07	Page Setup & Layout	17	Mail Merge Basics
08	Headers, Footers & Page Numbers	18	Long Documents: TOC & Footnotes
09	Working with Tables	19	Sharing, Exporting & Printing
10	Practice Assignment 2	20	Final Project: Build Your CV

▲ TODAY

Welcome to MS Word Essentials

1

Short, Focused Chapters

Short, focused sessions — one Word skill at a time.

2

Mostly Hands-On

About 60% of every chapter is practice — you'll be typing, not just watching.

3

20 Chapters

From your first document to mail merge and long-document tools.

4

Build Real Skills

Skills you'll use in real assignments, reports, and documents.

Goal: By the end of this course, you will know how to create and format documents. You will also know how to share them.

Today's Objectives

1

Navigate the Word Interface

Identify the Ribbon, Quick Access Toolbar, tabs, and status bar.

2

Create & Save a Document

Start a new document and save it in the right format and location.

3

Open & Edit Existing Files

Reopen a document, make changes, and save your progress.

4

Export to Another Format

Save a copy of your document as a PDF.

We'll close with a quick recap — keep these four goals in mind.

The Word Start Screen

1

Blank Document

The fastest way in — opens a clean page ready to type.

2

Template Gallery

Resumes, letters, and reports with the formatting already done.

3

Recent Documents

Jump straight back into anything you've worked on lately.

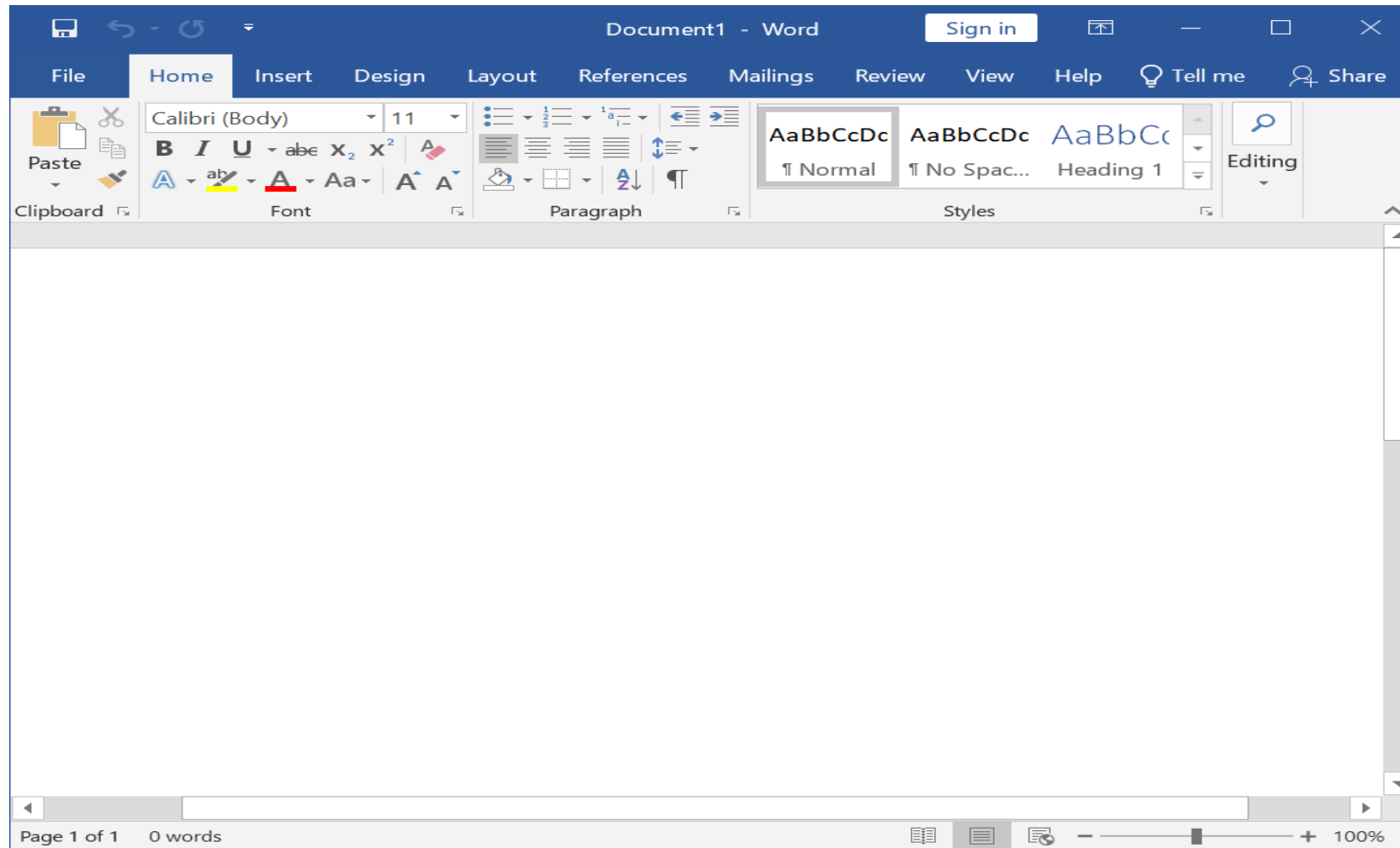
4

Pinned Files

Pin important documents so they never scroll out of view.



The Word Interface



1 Quick Access Toolbar

Top-left corner — one-click Save, Undo, and Redo, always visible.

2 The Ribbon

Tabs organize every tool into labeled, easy-to-find groups.

3 Document Area

The white page where you type — your document's real content.

4 Status Bar & Zoom

Shows page count, word count, and a zoom slider.

Ribbon Tabs Overview

1

Home & Insert

Home: fonts, paragraphs, styles. Insert: tables, pictures, shapes, links.

2

Design & Layout

Design: themes and page color. Layout: margins, orientation, columns.

3

References & Mailings

References: citations, TOC, footnotes. Mailings: mail merge, envelopes.

4

Review & View

Review: spelling, comments, track changes. View: layouts, zoom, rulers.

Document Views & Zoom

1

Print Layout

The default view — shows exactly how the page will print.

2

Read Mode

A clean, distraction-free view for reading on screen.

3

Web Layout

Shows how your document would look as a webpage.

4

Zoom Slider

Bottom-right corner — drag to zoom from 10% to 500%.

Creating, Saving & Opening Documents

1

Start a New Document

Ctrl+N, or File → New → Blank Document.

2

Save vs. Save As

Ctrl+S updates the same file. Save As (F12) creates a new copy or location.

3

Common File Formats

.docx for editing, .pdf for sharing, .rtf for compatibility with older software.

4

AutoSave & AutoRecover

Word saves backup copies automatically — but don't rely on it instead of Ctrl+S.

PRACTICE

Create & Save Your First Document

1**Start Blank**

Open a new blank document with Ctrl+N.

2**Type 3 Sentences**

Type these three sentences: "MS Word helps me create documents quickly. I am learning to type, save, and format files. These are the first skills toward becoming confident with computers."

3**Save It Properly**

Save as YourName_Chapter1.docx in a folder you'll remember.

4**Confirm It Saved**

Open File Explorer and check the file is really there.

PRACTICE

Reopen, Edit & Export

1

Close & Reopen

Close Word completely, then reopen your file from Recent Documents.

2

Make an Edit

Add this sentence to the end: “I look forward to learning more Word skills in the next chapters.” Save again with Ctrl+S.

3

Export to PDF

Use Save As → choose PDF → save a second copy of your file.

4

Check the PDF

Open the PDF copy and confirm it looks the same as your Word document.

Key Takeaways

1

The Ribbon Organizes Everything

Tabs group related tools together. For example, Home has text tools. Insert has objects.

2

Ctrl+S Is Your Best Friend

Save early, save often — don't rely on AutoSave alone.

3

Save As Makes Copies

Use it to change the format, name, or location of a file.

4

You Can Always Export

PDF export is one click away via Save As, for sharing anywhere.

Next up — Chapter 2: Basic Text Entry & Editing